



AA LEGAL

...Committed to excellence!!!

AI · MMXXVI



Artificial Intelligence

A Practical Automation Playbook

A practical, ethical guide to what AA Legal can automate, the tools that fit each task, step-by-step implementation, and visual walk-throughs — designed to free lawyers from administrative friction and let them focus on judgement, advocacy, and clients.



AUDIENCE

Partners · Staff · IT

JURISDICTION

Alberta, Canada

DOCUMENT

EDITION

In This Document



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Why AI Now, & Why It Matters for AA Legal

Roughly 40–60% of a typical lawyer's day is spent on tasks that do not require legal judgement — drafting boilerplate, summarising documents, hunting through emails, chasing payments, and re-typing intake data. Artificial intelligence can quietly eliminate most of that friction while keeping a human firmly in charge of every decision that matters.

TIME → VALUE

Reclaim Billable Hours

Automate intake, drafting first cuts, and document review so lawyers can spend more time on strategy, advocacy, and clients.

MARGIN → UP

Lower Cost-to-Serve

Flat-fee files become dramatically more profitable when AI handles 50–70% of the production work.

SPEED & CLARITY

Better Client Experience

Twenty-four-hour intake, plain-English document explanations, faster turnaround, and proactive status updates without staff overhead.

QUALITY → UP

Reduce Risk & Errors

AI-assisted deadline tracking, conflict checks, and second-eye review reduce the chance of missed limitations, fees, or clauses.

THE GUIDING PRINCIPLE

"AI helps us work faster and clearer, but every legal judgement, every document delivered to a client, and every word filed with a court is owned, reviewed, and signed by a human lawyer at AA Legal."

Fourteen High-Value Use Cases

Each entry describes a discrete automation: what it does, how to implement it, the recommended technology, the guardrails, and its business impact. These are building blocks — most firms start with two or three and grow from there.

24/7 Intake Assistant

USE CASE · I

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT LOW

What it does. A chatbot on aalegal.ca greets visitors, asks structured questions, captures matter type, urgency and contact information, and books a consult slot — even at two in the morning.

How to automate. Use an LLM-based chatbot (Smith.ai, LawDroid, or a custom GPT). Train it with practice-area FAQs, integrate with Clio Grow or Calendly for booking, and push leads into the CRM with conflict-check pre-screen.

GUARDRAILS

- ▶ Discloses it is an AI assistant
- ▶ Never gives legal advice — only collects information
- ▶ Escalates urgent matters to a human

AI-Assisted Drafting

USE CASE · II

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT MEDIUM

What it does. Generates first drafts of routine documents — wills, separation agreements, residential purchase contracts, demand letters — from a structured intake form.

How to automate. Build precedent templates in Word; use Gavel, LawYaw, or HotDocs to map intake fields to clauses; add an AI layer (Spellbook or Microsoft Copilot) for clause refinement and plain-English summaries. Lawyer reviews and signs off before client delivery.

BEST FOR

- ▶ Wills & POAs
- ▶ Residential real-estate documents
- ▶ Demand letters
- ▶ Standard contracts

Contract & Document Review

USE CASE · III

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT MEDIUM

What it does. Scans inbound contracts (purchase agreements, leases, condo documents, separation drafts) and flags missing clauses, unusual terms, deadlines, and risks.

How to automate. Use Spellbook, Kira, or Harvey for clause extraction; configure a checklist per matter type (e.g., a condo-document review checklist); the AI produces a red-flag report the lawyer then reviews.

TYPICAL OUTPUT

- ▶ Red-flag clause list
- ▶ Key dates calendar
- ▶ Comparison vs. firm standard
- ▶ Plain-English client summary

AI Legal Research

USE CASE · IV

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT LOW

What it does. Answers legal questions with citations to Canadian case law and statutes, drafts memos, and surfaces analogous decisions.

How to automate. Subscribe to Lexis+ AI Canada, Westlaw Edge Canada, or vLex Vincent. Use Harvey for memo drafting. Always verify citations — never rely on raw LLM output.

RULE ONE

- ▶ Verify every citation
- ▶ Confirm currency of case law
- ▶ Cross-check with CanLII
- ▶ Lawyer always re-reads cited authority

Email Triage & Drafting

USE CASE · V

IMPACT MEDIUM

EFFORT LOW

What it does. Sorts incoming email by urgency and matter, summarises long threads, and drafts reply suggestions in the lawyer's voice.

How to automate. Microsoft Copilot for Outlook or Google Gemini for Gmail. Build custom rules to auto-tag by client and matter. Receive a daily AI-summarised inbox briefing at 7 a.m.

OUTPUT

- ▶ Inbox briefing email
- ▶ Thread summaries
- ▶ Suggested replies
- ▶ Matter auto-tagging

Passive Time Capture & Billing Narratives

USE CASE · VI

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT LOW

What it does. Detects time spent in documents, emails, and calls; generates compliant billing narratives; flags non-billable items.

How to automate. Clio Duo, Smokeball AutoTime, or TimeSolv AI. Train the model on AA Legal's preferred narrative style. Lawyer approves the daily timesheet in one click.

REVENUE IMPACT

- ▶ Recover 10–20% of lost time
- ▶ Cleaner, more defensible narratives
- ▶ Faster invoicing cycle

Conflict Check & KYC Automation

USE CASE · VII

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT MEDIUM

What it does. Runs fuzzy-match conflict checks across past matters, automates LSA-compliant ID verification, and screens for PEPs and sanctions lists.

How to automate. Persona, Onfido, or Trulioo for ID verification; Clio Manage with AI fuzzy match for conflicts; automated FINTRAC screening API.

COMPLIANCE WINS

- ▶ Full LSA audit trail
- ▶ FINTRAC screening logged
- ▶ No client ID gaps

Deadline & Court-Rules Engine

USE CASE · VIII

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT MEDIUM

What it does. Calculates limitation periods, court filing deadlines, and IRCC processing timelines automatically from the matter type and key dates.

How to automate. LawToolBox, CalendarRules, or Clio's court-rules add-on. AI parses orders and pleadings, auto-creates calendar entries, and triggers reminders at 30 / 14 / 3 / 1 day(s).

WHY IT MATTERS

- ▶ Missed deadlines = malpractice
- ▶ Reduces calendaring labour
- ▶ Auto-cascades on order changes

Proactive Client Updates

USE CASE · IX

IMPACT MEDIUM

EFFORT LOW

What it does. Sends automatic milestone updates ("Your offer was accepted"; "Your PR application reached IRCC stage 2") in plain English.

How to automate. Workflow automation in Clio + Zapier / Make; AI-generated messages from matter status changes; delivered via client portal, email, and SMS.

CLIENT WIN

- ▶ Fewer "any update?" calls
- ▶ Higher NPS
- ▶ Lower receptionist load

Real-Estate Closing Workflow

USE CASE · X

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT HIGH

What it does. End-to-end automation: order title search → review condo documents → draft statement of adjustments → generate closing package → e-sign → register at Land Titles.

How to automate. Conveyancing software (Unity, ProSuite, or ConveyMore); AI condo-document summariser; remote commissioning via Notarius or Syngrafii.

VOLUME PLAY

- ▶ Halves time-per-file
- ▶ Standardises every closing
- ▶ Frees lawyer for ILAs & advice

Immigration Form & Eligibility AI

USE CASE · XI

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT MEDIUM

What it does. Calculates Comprehensive Ranking System scores, identifies the best program, pre-fills IRCC forms from client documents, and flags missing items.

How to automate. Tracker Corp, Tracttion, or INSZoom immigration platforms; OCR plus AI to extract data from passports, transcripts, and work letters; internal QA checklist before submission.

OUTPUT

- ▶ Program eligibility memo
- ▶ Pre-filled IRCC forms
- ▶ Missing-document checklist

Wills, POAs & Probate

USE CASE · XII

IMPACT HIGH

EFFORT MEDIUM

What it does. Generates wills, enduring powers of attorney, and personal directives from an online questionnaire; produces probate applications from a death certificate and asset inventory.

How to automate. Gavel or LawYaw mapped to AA Legal precedents; AI to summarise the will in plain English for the client; probate calculator and court-form auto-fill.

OUTPUT

- ▶ Will, POA, personal directive
- ▶ Plain-language client summary
- ▶ Probate application package

Family & Criminal Litigation Prep

USE CASE · XIII

IMPACT MEDIUM-HIGH

EFFORT HIGH

What it does. Indexes large disclosure sets, summarises witness statements and police reports, builds chronologies, prepares cross-examination outlines.

How to automate. Everlaw, Relativity, or Reveal for e-discovery; Harvey or Vincent for case summaries; an internal AI bot trained on the matter folder (with strict access control).

OUTPUT

- ▶ Indexed disclosure set
- ▶ Witness summaries
- ▶ Chronology document
- ▶ Cross-exam outline

Marketing & Content Engine

USE CASE · XIV

IMPACT MEDIUM

EFFORT LOW

What it does. Generates blog posts, social posts, the monthly newsletter, and SEO-optimised practice-area pages from outlines provided by the lawyer.

How to automate. ChatGPT Team or Claude for drafts (lawyer edits); Canva Magic Studio for visuals; Mailchimp with AI subject-line testing.

OUTPUT

- ▶ 2 blog posts / month
- ▶ 8–12 social posts
- ▶ Monthly newsletter

A Six-Layer Architecture

AA Legal's technology can be pictured as a six-storey building. Each floor has a job. Clients enter at the top, work flows downward through automation layers, and lawyers sit at the centre approving everything important.

I. Client Layer	How clients reach the firm Website, AI intake chatbot, client portal, secure document upload, e-signing, and SMS/email notifications. Goal: make AA Legal accessible 24/7 without overloading reception.
II. Intake & Triage	Turning enquiries into matters AI captures structured intake → conflict check → KYC/AML screening → matter-type triage → recommended fee model → consult booking. Goal: a zero-touch lead-to-consult pipeline.
III. Practice Automation	Where the work happens Document drafting, contract review, legal research, deadline calculation, immigration form prep, real-estate conveyancing, and e-discovery. Goal: cut routine production time by 50–70%.
IV. Lawyer Review	Human-in-the-loop Every AI output is reviewed and approved by Yemi or a delegated staff lawyer. AI never sends, files, or signs anything without explicit lawyer sign-off. Goal: maintain professional responsibility.
V. Compliance & Trust	Guardrails Trust ledger, billing & collections, FINTRAC reports, LSA audit trail, encrypted file storage, retention and destruction policy. Goal: pass any audit, any day.

VI.
Insights &
Growth

Closing the loop

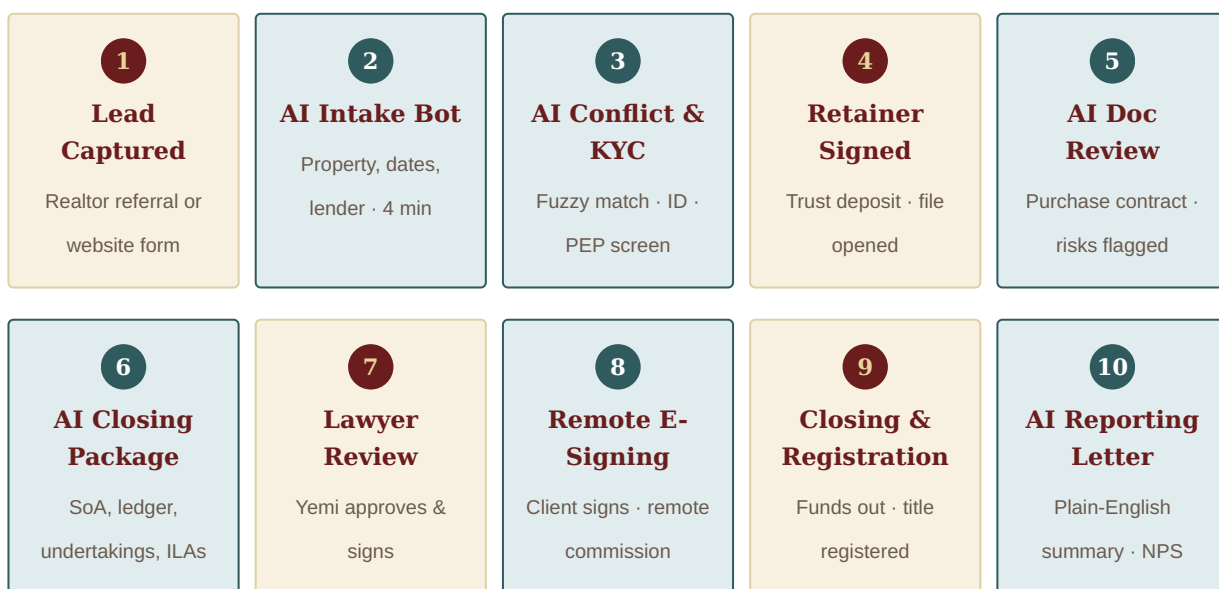
Dashboards on revenue, matter profitability, KPIs, client satisfaction, marketing performance. AI-generated content and review-request automation feed growth.

Goal: continuous improvement.

How AI Changes a Residential Purchase File

Follow a single residential purchase from enquiry to closing — with AI quietly doing the heavy lifting in the background.

RESIDENTIAL PURCHASE FILE — AI-AUGMENTED WORKFLOW



■ Steps shaded teal are AI-augmented. Lawyer sign-off remains mandatory at steps 4, 7, and 9.

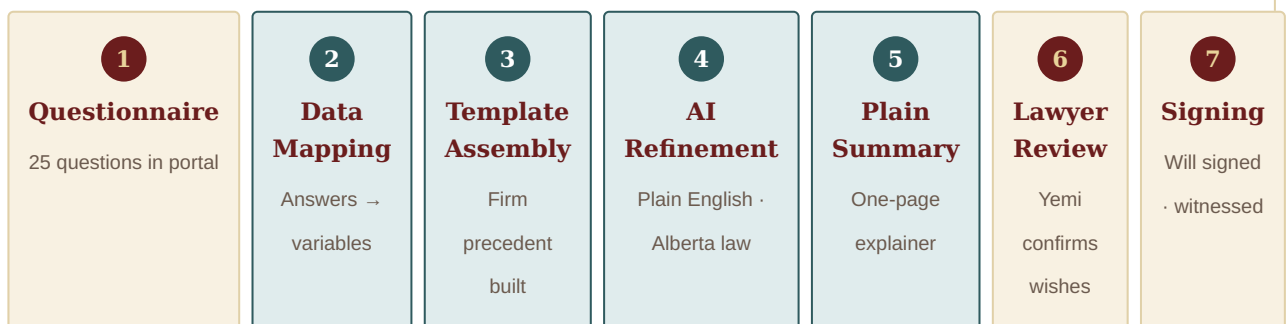
THE OUTCOME

A file that traditionally consumed 6–8 hours of staff time over four weeks is delivered in 2–3 hours of staff time over the same period — with fewer errors, faster client communication, and a higher margin on a flat fee.

How AI Drafts a Will, Step by Step

AI need not be a black box. Here is exactly what happens when AA Legal uses AI to draft a will, in plain language.

FROM CLIENT QUESTIONNAIRE TO FINISHED WILL



■ AI-augmented steps shown in teal.

WHAT THE AI NEVER DECIDES

The AI does not choose beneficiaries, draft trust structures for tax planning, advise on capacity, or sign anything. It is a production assistant — the lawyer remains the brain of the operation.

A 90-Day Rollout Plan

There is no need to do everything at once. The following phased plan delivers quick wins in the first month and compounds into a fully AI-augmented practice within a year.

PHASE 0

Week 1 — Foundations

Get the House in Order

- Adopt a practice management system (Clio recommended)
- Move email to Microsoft 365 with Canadian tenancy
- Enable MFA across all staff accounts
- Sign an LSA-compliant AI use policy

PHASE 1

Weeks 2-4 — Quick Wins

Low Risk, High Return

- Deploy the AI intake chatbot on aalegal.ca
- Turn on AI email summaries and drafts (Copilot)
- Switch to passive time capture (Clio Duo)
- Use ChatGPT Team or Claude for marketing content

PHASE 2

Weeks 5-8 — Production

Automate the Drafting

- Stand up Gavel or LawYaw for wills & POAs
- Adopt Spellbook for contract review
- Integrate Lexis+ AI or Westlaw Edge for research
- Train staff and build the precedent library

PHASE 3

Weeks 9-12 — Practice-Specific

Tailored Workflows

- Real-estate conveyancing automation
- Immigration form & eligibility tools
- Deadline / court-rules engine
- Client-portal milestone notifications

PHASE 4

Months 4-6 — Optimisation

Measure & Improve

- KPI dashboards for matters and profitability
- Internal AI knowledge base (firm-trained)
- E-discovery for litigation files
- Quarterly AI ethics and security review

PHASE 5

Months 7-12 — Differentiation

Become the AI-Forward Firm

- Custom AI assistant trained on firm precedents
- Client-facing AI services (document explainers)
- Thought leadership: blog, webinars on AI & law
- Articling student supervised on AI workflows

Vetted Tools by Function

A starter shortlist, all of which have Canadian data-residency options or are widely used in Canadian firms. Verify vendor terms before signing.

FUNCTION	RECOMMENDED TOOLS	WHY
Practice Management	Clio Manage, CosmoLex, PCLaw	Trust accounting, matters, billing
Intake Chatbot	Smith.ai, LawDroid, custom GPT	Legal-aware, Clio integration
Drafting	Gavel, LawYaw, HotDocs, Copilot	Conditional templates + polish
Contract Review	Spellbook, Kira, Harvey	Clause libraries & risk flags
Legal Research	Lexis+ AI Canada, Westlaw Edge, vLex Vincent, CanLII	Citations to Canadian law
Time Capture	Clio Duo, Smokeball AutoTime, TimeSolv	Passive capture & narratives
KYC / AML	Persona, Onfido, Trulioo	FINTRAC / LSA-compliant
Court Rules	LawToolBox, CalendarRules	Auto-calendared deadlines
E-Sign / Notary	DocuSign, Adobe Sign, Notarius, Syngrafii	Canadian legal compliance
Conveyancing	Unity, ProSuite, ConveyMore	Alberta Land Titles integration
Immigration	Tracker Corp, Tracktion, INSZoom	IRCC forms & eligibility
E-Discovery	Everlaw, Relativity, Reveal	Disclosure indexing & review
General LLM	ChatGPT Team, Claude for Work, Microsoft Copilot	Drafting · summaries · analysis

Non-Negotiables for AI in a Canadian Law Firm



The Law Society of Alberta has issued guidance on generative AI. AA Legal's use of AI must respect every one of the following.

Competence

Lawyers must understand the AI tools they use, their limitations, and verify all outputs — especially citations.

Confidentiality

Only use AI tools that contractually prohibit training on client data and offer Canadian or SOC-2-compliant hosting.

Privilege

Never paste privileged content into consumer LLMs. Use enterprise tiers with DPAs in place.

Supervision

Every AI output is reviewed by a qualified lawyer. AI does not sign, file, or advise.

Candour

Disclose AI use to clients where material, and to the court where required.

Fees

Bill fairly: efficiency gains from AI should reduce fees on hourly matters.

Bias & Fairness

Be alert to AI-introduced bias, particularly in family, criminal, and immigration matters.

Records & Audit

Keep an audit log of significant AI uses on each file. Update retainer language to disclose AI tools.

Indicative Budget & ROI

Costs vary by vendor and seat count. These are realistic 2026 estimates for a small Canadian firm with one lawyer and two support staff.

CATEGORY	MONTHLY (CAD)	NOTES
Practice management (Clio Suite)	\$300 – \$500	Per seat; includes Clio Duo AI
AI drafting / contract review	\$200 – \$600	Spellbook or Gavel
Legal research AI	\$200 – \$400	Lexis+ AI / Westlaw Edge
Intake chatbot	\$150 – \$400	Smith.ai or similar
KYC / ID verification	\$2 – \$5 per check	Variable, only when used
Microsoft 365 + Copilot	\$50 – \$70 per seat	Canadian tenancy
E-sign / notarisation	\$50 – \$150	DocuSign / Notarius
Total (typical)	≈ \$1,200 – \$2,500 / month	Plus one-off setup ≈ \$3–5K

EXPECTED PAYBACK

If AI saves a single lawyer just one hour per day, at a billed rate of \$350 per hour over 220 working days, that is approximately \$77,000 of recovered capacity per year — a 25–50× return on a typical AI budget.

KPIs to Track Once AI Is Live



Time-to-First-Draft

TARGET · -60%

Across wills, real-estate,
simple immigration

Client NPS

TARGET · ≥ 70

Surveyed at file close

Matter Profitability

TARGET · +25%

Gross margin on flat-fee
matters

Error / Re-Work Rate

TARGET · $\leq 2\%$

Files requiring substantive
correction

Intake-to-Consult

TARGET · < 24h

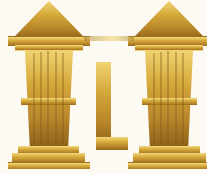
Chatbot answers $\geq 70\%$ of
FAQs

Compliance Findings

TARGET · ZERO

LSA audit; 100% conflict /
KYC coverage

"AI is not a replacement for the wisdom, judgement, and compassion that define AA Legal — it is a force-multiplier for them. Start small, measure honestly, keep the lawyer in charge."



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